



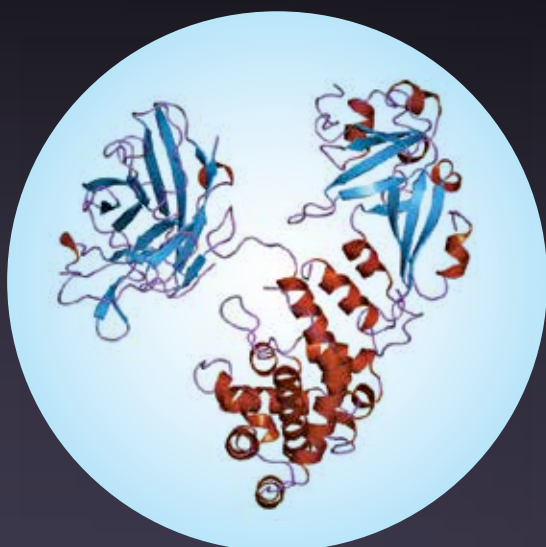
Facebook plans voter drive

Facebook has partnered with TurboVote and will reportedly push users to register to vote.
<https://dgit.in/oct18-95-1>



Degree in Blockchain

A New York based University is the first to offer students a major in Blockchain technology.
<https://dgit.in/oct18-95-2>

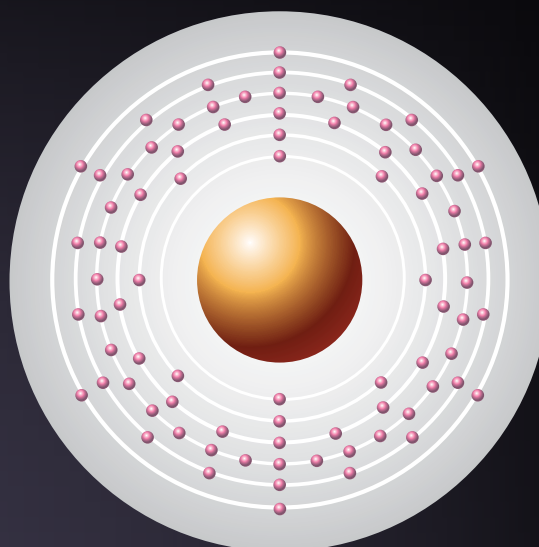


Diphtheria toxin

LD50: 10ng/kg

Produced by: *Corynebacterium diphtheriae*

Apart from its high toxicity, one of the interesting things about the Diphtheria toxin is that it is not solely generated by the bacteria responsible. The gene that leads to the toxin generation is actually encoded by a lysogenic bacteriophage, as in, a virus infecting a bacteria. This toxin leads to the necrosis of the heart and the liver and also leads to myocarditis, one of the biggest risks to unimmunized children.

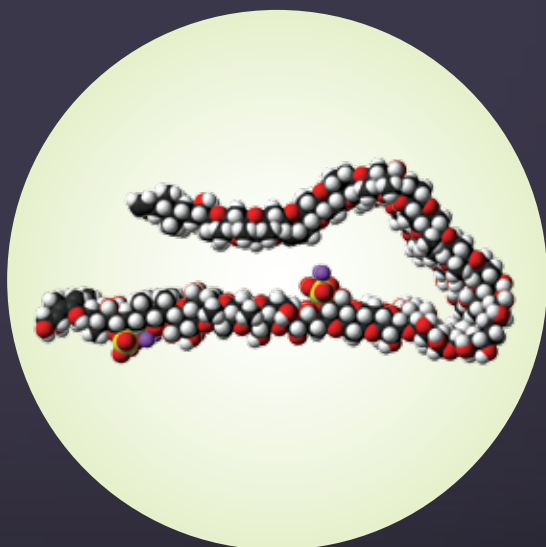


Polonium 210

LD50: 10ng/kg

Produced by: Nature/Nuclear Reactor

Perhaps one of the most recently talked about poisons, Polonium 210 is an isotope of Polonium, a rare and radioactive metal. Its emission of large amounts of alpha particles makes it harmful. Polonium 210 can only cause significant damage if ingested or inhaled, where it acts like a close-range weapon on living cells. The death of Alexander Litvinenko in 2006 is regarded as the first known case.

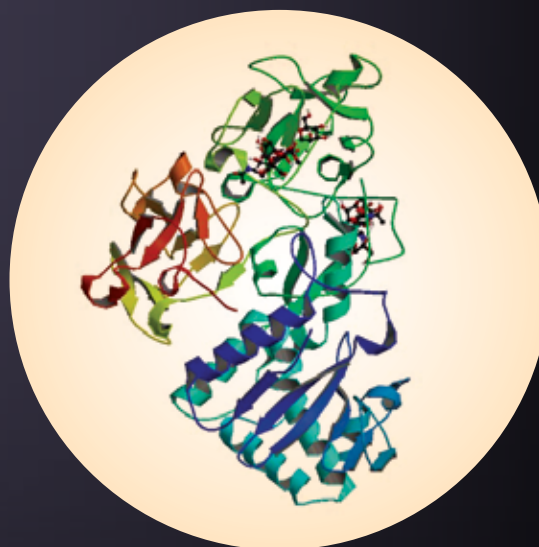


Maitotoxin

LD50: 130ng/kg

Produced by: *Gambierdiscus toxicus*

At a molecular level, maitotoxin is unique for more than its toxicity – it is the largest natural molecule that is neither a protein nor a sugar nor any other kind of polymer. Named after the fish *Ctenochaetus striatus*, called 'maito' in Tahiti, from which it was first isolated, maitotoxin works by interfering with calcium channels in the body, affecting muscles, neurons and hormones, leading to heart failure.



Abrin

LD50: 700ng/kg

Produced by: Rosary pea

One of the most lethal naturally occurring toxins, Abrin is also water soluble. There's no known record of it being weaponised. The outer shell of the seed of the rosary pea is hard enough for most animals to pass it undamaged. However, it is used in making beaded jewellery, in which case, the punctures created on the shell can prove fatal if the seed is swallowed or brushes against an open cut or damaged skin.